

Spanish AfterLife



Ciudad de las Artes y las Ciencias — Valencia, Spain

Your Complete Guide to Retiring in Spain

Everything North Americans need to know about the visa, the property, and the life.

spanishafterlife.com

Why Spain. Why Now.

Spain is not a retirement plan. It is a decision. And the people who make it early — while they still have the health, energy, and resources to build a real life here — are the ones who look back and wonder why they waited at all.

This guide is for North Americans who have started running the numbers. What your money buys at home versus what it buys in Spain. What your days look like now versus what they could look like. The visa process, the property market, the practical reality of making the move.

It is written to be useful, not inspiring. Spain will do the inspiring itself.



Oliva Nova beach, Valencia Community

“Your first life was the warm-up.” — Spanish AfterLife

The Math Most People Don't Do

The average detached home in Toronto or Vancouver sells for over \$1.2M CAD. In California, similar. In the Valencia Community of Spain, a three-bedroom property with outdoor space, near the Mediterranean, costs between €200,000 and €500,000 — often less inland.

The cost-of-living difference is equally significant. A straightforward comparison for a professional couple:

Category	Canada / US	Valencia, Spain
----------	-------------	-----------------

Monthly rent (2BR)	CAD \$3,500–5,000	€900–1,800
Groceries (couple)	CAD \$1,200–1,600	€600–900
Dining out (2 people)	CAD \$80–150	€30–60
Golf membership	CAD \$5,000–15,000/yr	€1,500–4,000/yr
Healthcare (private)	Varies / costly	€100–250/mo
Days of sunshine	~200 per year	~300 per year

These are indicative figures. Individual circumstances vary. But the direction is consistent: your money goes significantly further in Spain.

The Visa: What You Actually Need to Know

Most North Americans retire to Spain on one of two visas. The right choice depends on your income sources, tax situation, and whether you plan to work remotely. Spanish AfterLife works with a vetted immigration and tax law firm for all applications — this overview is to orient you, not replace legal advice.

Non-Lucrative Visa (NLV)

The flagship route for retirees and those living on passive income — investments, pensions, rental income, savings.

- Minimum income requirement: approximately €2,400/month for an individual, around €3,000/month for a couple (2026)
- Valid for one year, renewable for two-year periods
- Does not permit you to work for a Spanish employer
- Leads to permanent residency after five years
- Applied for at the Spanish Consulate in your home country before you arrive

The NLV is the most common route for our clients. If you have pension income, investment returns, or proceeds from a property sale, you likely qualify.

Digital Nomad Visa (DNV)

Introduced in 2023, for those who work remotely for non-Spanish companies or clients.

- Minimum income requirement: approximately €2,850/month for an individual (2026)
- Permits remote work — you must earn at least 80% of income from outside Spain

- May access the Beckham Law tax regime — a flat 24% rate on Spanish employment income (up to €600,000) for up to six years, for those employed by a non-Spanish company
- Valid for one year, renewable for two-year periods

The Beckham regime applies to employed remote workers, not freelancers, and generally does not benefit retirees living on pensions or investments. Your specific tax position is something our partner firm assesses case by case.

Key Steps After Visa Approval

- NIE — Número de Identificación de Extranjero. Your Spanish ID number. Required for everything.
- Empadronamiento — register at your local town hall. Required for residency and many services.
- Spanish bank account — essential for bills, property transactions, and daily life.
- Spanish tax registration — required within the first year of residency.

Spanish AfterLife handles all of this with our partner immigration law firm. You will never be navigating Spanish bureaucracy alone.

Property in the Valencia Community

The Valencia Community is Spain's third largest region, stretching along the Mediterranean coast. It encompasses Valencia city, the Costa Blanca, and a diverse inland landscape of mountains, rivers, and agricultural towns. It is where we operate.

Property here represents exceptional value by any international comparison — and the market has been strengthening consistently as more Europeans and North Americans discover what locals have always known.

Where Our Clients Buy

- Valencia city — urban living, world-class food and culture, €150,000–600,000+
- Jávea — boutique coastal town, international community, sailing culture, €300,000–1,500,000+
- Denia — larger coastal city, year-round market, ferry to Ibiza, €200,000–800,000+
- Oliva — quieter beach town, long sandy coastline, excellent value, €150,000–500,000+
- Cullera — dramatic cliff and beach setting, close to Valencia city, €150,000–400,000+
- Ontinyent inland — rural fincas, olive groves, complete silence, €100,000–400,000+

The Buying Process

Buying property in Spain as a foreigner is straightforward when you have the right team:

- Obtain your NIE — required before any property transaction
- Open a Spanish bank account — for the purchase transfer
- Sign an arras contract — reservation agreement with typically 10% deposit
- Due diligence — title search, ITP tax calculation, legal checks
- Sign the escritura pública — deed of sale at a notary
- Register the property at the land registry

Purchase costs (taxes, notary, registration, legal fees) typically add 10–13% to the purchase price. Factor this into your budget from the start.

Spanish AfterLife is a licensed buyer's agency. We represent you, not the seller. Our fee comes from the selling agent's commission — you pay nothing extra.

What the Life Actually Looks Like

Beyond the numbers, Spain rewards people who are ready to live differently. Not slower — better.



Oliva beach at sunrise — 300 days of sun a year

- 300 days of sunshine annually in the Valencia Community
- World-class golf courses from €40–80 per round
- Padel — Spain's favourite sport — courts everywhere, culture built around it
- Michelin-starred restaurants alongside €12 three-course lunches with wine
- Direct flights to London in 2 hours, Paris in 2.5, most of Europe within 3
- Access to Spain's healthcare system, public and private
- A food culture built on markets, seasons, and time at the table

- Mediterranean coastline from dramatic cliffs to long open beaches

The quality of daily life in the Valencia Community is not a projection. It is the lived reality of the people already here — and the reason the ones who come rarely go back.

How Spanish AfterLife Works

Spanish AfterLife is a vertically integrated concierge — immigration and real estate under one roof, one point of contact throughout.

Immigration Concierge

- Visa eligibility assessment
- Application preparation and submission
- NIE and empadronamiento
- Spanish bank account opening
- Tax registration and Beckham Law assessment
- Post-arrival settlement support

Buyer's Real Estate Agency

- Property search based on your brief and budget
- Viewings coordinated and attended
- Offer negotiation on your behalf
- Arras contract and due diligence coordination
- Notary appointment and escritura
- Post-purchase setup — utilities, insurance, community fees

Private Client

For clients who want a fully managed end-to-end experience — from the first conversation to the morning you wake up in Spain — we offer a Private Client package that covers everything.

Your Next Step

The best time to start is before you are ready. The visa process takes time. The property search takes time. The earlier you begin, the better positioned you will be when you are ready to move.

Spanish AfterLife offers a complimentary initial consultation — a straightforward conversation about your situation, your timeline, and whether Spain is the right move for you.

No pressure. No pitch. Just an honest conversation with someone who left North America for Spain and now lives and works in the Valencia Community.

Get in touch:

hola@spanishafterlife.com
spanishafterlife.com

Why wait for the AfterLife?

Spanish AfterLife — Valencia Community, Spain — spanishafterlife.com